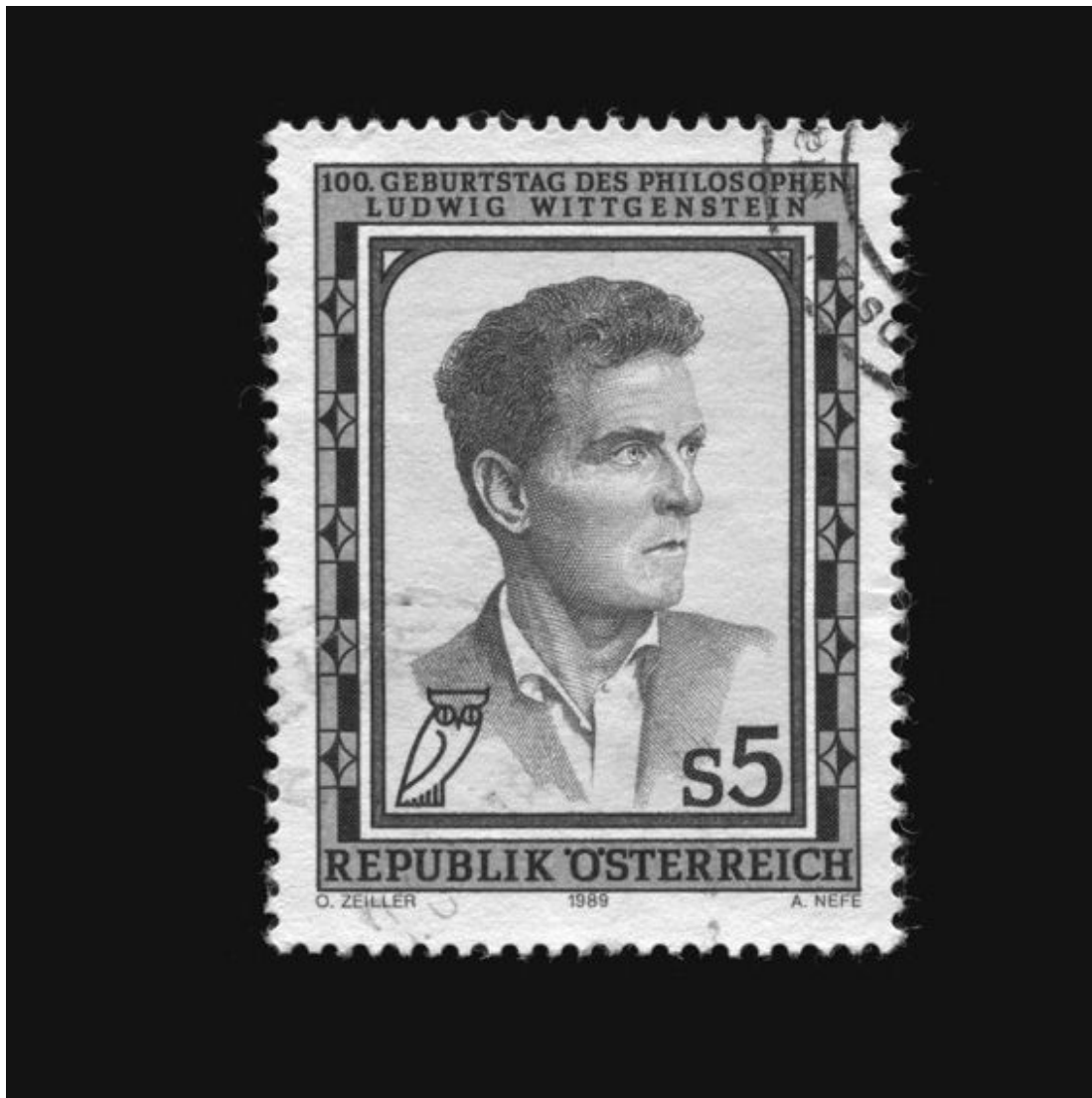


Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus



As a student of Russell, Ludwig Wittgenstein adopted the principles of analytic philosophy, then set out to establish the limits of our knowledge using logic in the same way that Kant and Schopenhauer had previously used epistemology. In *Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus* (1921), he showed that in trying to understand the world, we describe it using language that consists of propositions with logical structures: 'The totality of propositions is language.' The world, 'the totality of facts, not things', is also structured, and language pictures the world by making a representation, or 'map', in the same logical form as the world it describes. All that can be meaningfully

said is ‘the totality of true propositions’, statements that can be empirically verified about the phenomenal world of experience. Philosophy should confine itself to this world, since language limits the things it can meaningfully discuss, in effect, to statements about natural science. Subjects such as ethics and religion are still important, Wittgenstein said, but are ‘mystical’ – we can make no meaningful propositions about them.